Marsing, Prieto had more support than reports indicate

Letter to the editor, Longmont Times-Call, December 12, 2025, by Gaythia Weis, Longmont. Text as published, as circulated by the author to the LWVBC Voting Methods Team.

In the recent Longmont City Council election, Longmont voters could cast up to two votes for their favorite at large city council candidates. Some voted for two candidates, some only for one, some for no candidates. This means that the correct way to evaluate support for these candidates is to look at the number of votes that the candidate received as a percentage of ballots cast, (the number of voters voting), not the number of votes cast in that race. Election results are reported by county clerks on their websites, Longmont is mostly in Boulder County but extends into Weld County.

In the Summary of Votes Report on the bouldercounty.gov/elections/results webpage, you can see the there were 33,920 total ballots cast in the Longmont at-large council race, with Jake Marsing receiving 15,265 votes. Weld County had significantly fewer participants and I did not find the cast ballot data. Marsing got 76 votes in Weld County out of 220. Thus, the Boulder County results indicate that he had the support of about 45% of voters. Crystal Prieto had 12,895 Boulder County votes and 67 Weld County votes, indicating about 38% voter support.

Published reports that Jake Marsing got 29.17% and Crystal Prieto got 24.64% of “the votes” hides each candidates actual support.

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